OSCE Stations

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OSCE Guides

Respiratory History | OSCE Checklist

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Opening the consultation		
1	Wash your hands and don PPE if appropriate	
2	Introduce yourself to the patient including your name and role	
3	Confirm the patient's name and date of birth	
4	Explain that you would like to take a history from the patient	
5	Gain consent to proceed with taking a history	
Presenting complaint		
6	Start by using open questions to explore the patient's presenting complaint; facilitate the patient to expand on their presenting complaint	
History of presenting complaint		
7	Explore the presenting complaint in more detail using SOCRATES (site, onset, character, radiation, associated symptoms, time course, exacerbating and relieving factors, severity)	
8	Screen for key respiratory symptoms (dyspnoea, cough, haemoptysis, wheeze, chest pain, weight loss)	
9	Explore the patient's ideas, concerns and expectations	
10	Summarise the patient's presenting complaint	
Systemic enquiry		
11	Screen for relevant symptoms in other body systems	
Past medical history		
12	Ask if the patient has any medical conditions. Ask about pre-existing respiratory disease (e.g. asthma, COPD) and previous respiratory infections	
13	Ask the patient if they've previously undergone any surgeries or procedures (e.g. lobectomy, bronchoscopy)	
14	Ask about other medical diagnoses and previous surgical history	
15	Ask the patient if they've been vaccinated against respiratory diseases such as influenza, pneumococcus, COVID-19 and tuberculosis	

Drug history		
16	Ask if the patient is currently taking any prescribed medications or over- the-counter remedies	
17	Ask if the patient has any allergies and if so, clarify what kind of reaction they had to the substance	
Family history		
18	Ask if there is any family history of respiratory disease. If present, clarify at what age the diseases developed in the relatives	
Social history		
19	Explore the patient's general social context (type of accommodation, who the patient lives with, how the patient manages with ADLs)	
20	Take a smoking history	
21	Take an alcohol history	
22	Ask about recreational drug use	
23	Ask about exposure to allergens, such as animal dander, pollen and dust	
24	Ask about the patient's occupation now and in the past to determine if there has been any exposure to any pulmonary irritants or other hazardous substances (e.g. asbestos)	
25	If the patient's symptoms are suggestive of an infective aetiology (e.g. tuberculosis), take a travel history to assess exposure risk	
26	Ask about hobbies (e.g. bird keeping, caving)	
Closing the consultation		
27	Summarise the key points	
28	Ask the patient if they have any questions or concerns that have not been addressed	
29	Thank the patient for their time	
30	Dispose of PPE appropriately and wash your hands	
Key communication skills		
31	Active listening	
32	Summarising	
33	Signposting	

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